PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Syllabic L

It is helpful to know about syllabic "L" to over-pronouncing words in English. You pronounce the “L” exactly as you would otherwise; only you do not actually emphasize or pronounce the vowel before it. So, for example, the word “fuel” would not be pronounced “few **el**” but more like “fe**wl**” /fjuwl/. The word “bagel” would not be pronounced “beh gel” with the vowel “e” pronounced clearly, but more like “beh gl,” with the vowel dropped.

Let’s look at some syllabic “L” words below to avoid over-pronouncing the vowel before it:

animal	local
bagel	medical
awful	metal
cultural	model
especially	potentially
fuel	successful
hospital	wonderful